AFRICAN SOLIDARITY CIVIC ORGANISATION (ASCO)
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SARS Approved PBO: 930092287
Section 18A Approved ? Effective 9 October 2026
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CORPORATE CSI PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

Gold Fields / South Deep Education Trust × ASCO

South Deep Youth Learning and Community Leadership Initiative

Requested CSI investment: R50,000

Proposed implementation area: West Rand District Municipality, Gauteng, prioritising a confirmed South Deep host community such as Simunye Westonaria or Bekkersdal, subject to SDET approval and local consultation

Prepared: October 2026

Confidential proposal for corporate CSI / ESG consideration. This document presents a proposed partnership and does not represent an award, endorsement, existing partnership or company commitment.

Executive summary

ASCO is seeking a strategic corporate CSI partnership with **Gold Fields / South Deep Education Trust** to support a measurable public-benefit initiative: **South Deep Youth Learning and Community Leadership Initiative**. The proposed request is **R50,000**, to be applied to direct programme delivery, participation access, safety, learning materials, monitoring and accountable reporting.

ASCO is approved to issue Section 18A receipts effective 9 October 2026. Receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for the approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability.

> **The proposal in one sentence:** South Deep Youth Learning and Community Leadership Initiative in West Rand District Municipality, Gauteng, prioritising a confirmed South Deep host community such as Simunye Westonaria or Bekkersdal, subject to SDET approval and local consultation, benefiting Proposed: approximately 50 disadvantaged secondary-school learners and/or out-of-school youth from a confirmed South Deep host community, with priority to historically disadvantaged, low-income young people and deliberate inclusion of girls and other historically marginalised participants. Final eligibility and numbers should be validated with SDET. through a locally designed, monitored and reportable intervention aligned with Gold Fields / South Deep Education Trust's publicly documented priorities, subject to the company's confirmation of eligibility and application requirements.

What ASCO is requesting
R50,000 in CSI support, or a partial/in-kind contribution structured with the company.

What the funding would enable
Direct activities, participation access, safe delivery, community materials, monitoring and a close-out report.

About ASCO

ASCO is a community-focused civic organisation promoting social justice, community development, active citizenship, African unity, environmental sustainability, inclusion and sustainable public-benefit action. ASCO works through advocacy, education, grassroots initiatives, humanitarian and community-development activities, partnerships and practical interventions.

ASCO is governed by four Directors. The Board governs and Executive Management manages. ASCO maintains governance, donation, safeguarding, financial-management, data-protection, monitoring and reporting instruments for responsible partnership administration.

ASCO's primary contact for this proposal is:

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Executive Director
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The proposed project

Project title
South Deep Youth Learning and Community Leadership Initiative

Implementation period
Proposed 6–12 month pilot, with final schedule agreed after eligibility, baseline and permissions are confirmed.

Location
West Rand District Municipality, Gauteng, prioritising a confirmed South Deep host community such as Simunye Westonaria or Bekkersdal, subject to SDET approval and local consultation

Target beneficiaries
Proposed: approximately 50 disadvantaged secondary-school learners and/or out-of-school youth from a confirmed South Deep host community, with priority to historically disadvantaged, low-income young people and deliberate inclusion of girls and other historically marginalised participants. Final eligibility and numbers should be validated with SDET.

Proposed outputs and targets

The following are proposed planning targets, not completed results. Final targets should be agreed with the company after baseline assessment, budget confirmation and any required stakeholder permissions.

- Proposed: recruit and support 50 eligible local youth through an education, civic-participation and community-development programme over one project cycle.
- Proposed: deliver 10 structured learning and youth-participation workshops covering study/career pathways, civic responsibility, leadership and community problem-solving.
- Proposed: facilitate 5 youth-led community improvement activities, with documented participation, safeguarding and local stakeholder sign-off.
- Proposed: provide 50 participant learning/resource packs and track attendance, completion and referrals using consent-based records.
- Proposed: produce one end-of-project report with expenditure reconciliation, outputs, anonymised participation data, lessons learned and sustainability/referral recommendations.

Expected outcomes

- Improved community participation and practical public-benefit action in the selected location.
- Improved access to relevant learning, environmental, inclusion, humanitarian or youth-development support, depending on the project design.
- Documented implementation evidence, beneficiary participation and lessons for continuation or scale-up.
- Clear accountability through expenditure records, activity updates, monitoring information and a close-out report.

Why this matters

The proposed intervention responds to a community-development need through the sequence **community need → practical intervention → measurable result**. The final baseline will verify the

specific need, beneficiary profile, site conditions, permissions and appropriate indicators before implementation.

ASCO will avoid overstating the problem or claiming results in advance. Where waste, participation, learning, environmental condition, referrals or other outputs are measurable, ASCO will use simple evidence tools such as attendance registers, baseline/endline checks, activity logs, photographs with consent, beneficiary feedback and expenditure records.

> **Evidence discipline:** All numbers in this proposal are either company-reported context from official sources or clearly labelled ASCO planning targets. No completed result, partnership or funding commitment is claimed.

Why Gold Fields / South Deep Education Trust?

ASCO is approved to issue Section 18A receipts effective 9 October 2026. Receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for the approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability.

Verified company context

- The South Deep Education Trust (SDET) was established in 2010 as an independent but interconnected trust alongside the South Deep Community Trust, serving communities in municipal wards neighbouring the South Deep operation and labour-sending areas in the Eastern Cape and KwaZulu-Natal.
- The SDET report states that it invested more than R76 million since inception through 2023 to improve access to quality basic and post-school education in host communities and labour-sending areas.
- The SDET deed lists education objectives including educational facilities, tuition, scholarships, bursaries, skills development, school buildings or equipment, curriculum support, school development, school safety and security, outreach, study and research.
- The deed also permits community-based projects involving self-help, poverty alleviation, empowerment, capacity-building, training and support for emerging micro-enterprises, and funding to directly linked labour-sending areas for those purposes.
- The SDET trust report identifies West Rand District Municipality as a served area and lists communities including Bekkersdal, Thusanang, Cardoville, Hillshaven, Waterpan, Venterspost, Glenharvie, Leeudorn, Wagterskop, Kalbasfontein, Zuurbekom, Poortjie, Simunye Westonaria and Libanon, as well as Gold Fields South Deep.
- Gold Fields' 2024 host-community reporting says South Deep education and skills programmes are delivered through its Social and Labour Plan and South Deep trusts; it also says South Africa independent trusts are among delivery channels for socio-economic development investment.

Company facts are drawn from official sources reviewed for this proposal. They describe public priorities or reported company activity; they are not promises of funding to ASCO.

Indicative project budget

The requested amount is allocated transparently across delivery and accountability categories. The budget is indicative and should be refined with the company after the implementation site, beneficiary profile, quotations and eligible-cost rules are confirmed.

Budget category	Indicative amount	Use
Direct programme implementation	R30,000	Core activities, local delivery inputs and community implementation for the proposed project.
Participant transport and access	R4,000	Reasonable access support to enable participation, subject to eligibility and records.
Safety equipment and participant welfare	R3,000	PPE, first aid, safeguarding, water/refreshments and safe participation requirements.
Educational and mobilisation materials	R4,000	Learning resources, community mobilisation and accessible communication.
Monitoring, evaluation and reporting	R3,500	Baseline, attendance, outcome tracking, documentation and close-out reporting.
Volunteer/project coordination	R3,500	Scheduling, volunteer support, stakeholder coordination and implementation management.
Reasonable administration	R2,000	Reasonable project administration directly attributable to delivery; no inflated overheads.
Total requested CSI investment	**R50,000**	**Equals the proposed request.**

Administration is limited to a reasonable project share. ASCO will not promise audited financial statements unless they are available; it will provide appropriate project expenditure records and supporting documentation.

Partnership options

Option A — Full project funding
Company funds the proposed project at R50,000, subject to approval and agreement.

Option B — Partial project funding
Company contributes a defined portion of the budget, with scope and outputs adjusted transparently.

Option C — Multi-phase partnership
Company supports a pilot followed by an agreed continuation or scale-up phase based on evidence.

In-kind or technical support
Where relevant, equipment, expertise, access or employee volunteering may complement cash support, subject to written agreement.

Accountability and reporting

ASCO will maintain appropriate records relating to funded activities and can provide, subject to agreed requirements:

- Project implementation updates
- Expenditure records and supporting documentation
- Attendance and participation information where appropriate and lawfully collected
- Photographs and activity evidence with appropriate consent
- Safeguarding and incident records where relevant
- Monitoring and outcome information
- Activity and close-out reports

ASCO will agree reporting frequency, eligible costs, procurement expectations, data protection, branding, acknowledgement and any site-access or technical requirements before implementation. Any use of company branding or recognition will be subject to written approval.

Initial contact route

Not found: the reviewed current Gold Fields/SDET official pages and reports did not provide a current public application or contact route for organisational proposals. The historical 2016 form is not a current route. Use Gold Fields' official website contact/navigation to request the current South Deep Education Trust application process and confirm whether an ASCO organisational proposal is eligible; do not rely on the historical closing date.

ASCO welcomes an initial discussion to confirm whether the proposed project is within the company's current CSI/ESG remit, whether unsolicited proposals are accepted, what documents are required, and whether the full, partial or in-kind partnership option is most suitable.

Important conditions and open questions

- The only located educational-grant application form is marked 2016, with a 30 October 2016 closing date; its deadline, contacts and criteria must be re-confirmed with Gold Fields/SDET before submission.
- No current official open-call, current application portal or current SDET contact route was located in the reviewed official sources; contact route is therefore reported as not found below.
- The Trust deed gives trustees broad discretion over beneficiary selection and distributions; submission does not guarantee funding.
- Geographic fit must be demonstrated: the proposal should identify beneficiaries in listed South Deep host communities or qualifying labour-sending areas, rather than assume any South African community qualifies.
- The historical grant route is primarily for individual tertiary students and may not apply to an organisational project; obtain written confirmation that an ASCO-led project is an eligible funding vehicle.
- Do not claim that ASCO has Section 18A approval, completed results, existing Gold Fields/SDET partnerships, or any company commitment. The R50,000 is ASCO's requested amount, not a confirmed award.

These cautions are included to prevent overstatement. They should be resolved with the company before ASCO treats the proposal as eligible or finalises a submission budget.

Closing

ASCO believes meaningful social and environmental progress is achieved through collaboration between communities, civil society and responsible corporate partners. We invite **Gold Fields / South Deep Education Trust** to join us in delivering measurable public-benefit impact through a carefully scoped and accountable partnership.

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Official sources and verification links

Important company and programme information in this proposal was checked against the following official sources:

1. https://www.goldfields.com/pdf/sustainbility/foundations-and-trusts/south-deep-trusts-2012-2023-new.pdf
2. https://www.goldfields.com/pdf/sustainbility/foundations-and-trusts/south-deep-education-trust-deed.pdf
3. https://www.goldfields.com/communities.php
4. https://www.goldfields.com/reports/annual-report-2024/host-communities.php
5. https://www.goldfields.com/pdf/media/publications/regions/south-africa/2016/south-deep-working-together-with-our-communities-t.pdf

Source review and proposal preparation date: October 2026. Company information and application routes can change; ASCO should confirm current requirements before submission.